

POCO X6 Pro 5G

Peak performance, unmatched value

Tech enthusiasts will undoubtedly reminisce about POCO's initiation of the 'flagship killer' movement with the iconic POCO F1. Since then, the brand has consistently demonstrated commitment to delivering unparalleled value without compromising on quality. Fast forward to 2024, and POCO continues this legacy with the introduction of its POCO X6 series of smartphones. In my hands for review is the POCO X6 Pro 5G, a device that left me in awe of its formidable power, complemented by a robust array of specifications and features.

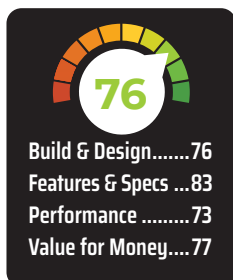
The POCO X6 Pro 5G sets the bar high for phones under ₹30,000. It boasts the formidable Dimensity 8300 Ultra processor, an AMOLED 1.5K resolution display, rapid 67 W charging, immersive stereo speakers, and a 64 MP OIS-enabled camera. However, amidst the ever-intensifying competition in the Indian market, the pertinent question arises: Can the POCO X6 Pro 5G carve out a distinctive space for itself? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The POCO X6 Pro 5G is offered in three color options – Spectre Black, Racing Grey, and the quintessential POCO Yellow. The yellow variant stands out with its premium vegan leather rear panel, while the other two feature glossy plastic back panels. However, a notable issue arises with the latter as they tend to accumulate fingerprints and smudges rapidly. A case is almost necessary for the non-leather variants.

Despite this concern, the phone boasts a solid build quality. Its compact design makes it easy to hold, and the rounded edges on the back enhance the

₹26,999



overall comfort of wielding it. I got the Racing Grey variant for review. This version showcases a dual-tone design on the back, with the rectangular camera module in black, contrasting against the grey rear panel. The camera module houses three cameras and an LED flash within four circular rings, and the POCO branding is positioned on the right side. At the bottom of the rear panel, a simple 5G symbol is present.

Although the phone's frame is crafted from plastic, it cleverly mimics the appearance of metal. The right side features tactile volume rocker and power buttons. The bottom of the phone houses the USB-C charging port, a SIM card tray, and a speaker. At the top, there's another speaker along with the return of the IR blaster. On the front, a flat display with slim bezels and a punch-hole cutout for the selfie camera completes the device. There's an in-display fingerprint sensor which proved to work almost flawlessly in my time using the device.

DISPLAY

The POCO X6 Pro 5G boasts a monstrous display. With a 6.67-inch AMOLED screen, it delivers a sharp 1.5K resolution, supports a staggering 68 billion colors, and operates at a smooth 120 Hz refresh rate. The inclusion of Dolby Vision and HDR10+ support elevates its status as a top contender for content consumption under ₹30,000.

The display itself is vibrant, providing crisp visuals with deep blacks and outstanding contrast. HDR content looks sublime. You've got decent viewing angles and exceptional brightness levels, reaching up to 1,440 nits during testing (though POCO advertises up to 1,800 nits of peak brightness), make it easily readable even in the brightest outdoor conditions. This brightness feature ensures usability on the sunniest of days.

Enhancing the overall multimedia experience, the phone is equipped with dual stereo speakers featuring Dolby Atmos and Hi-Res Audio support. While these speakers produce full-bodied and rich sound, they could be a bit louder, in my opinion.

PERFORMANCE

Performance is at the core of POCO's strategy, and it unquestionably excels here. It stands out as the first smartphone in India to feature the MediaTek Dimensity 8300 Ultra chipset – a flagship-grade powerhouse clocking in at a maximum speed of 3.35 GHz. Teamed up with the processor is up to 12 GB LPDDR5X RAM and up to 512 GB UFS 4.0 storage. Notably, POCO has chosen the 256 GB storage variant as the base model, a commendable decision.

Let's kick things off with synthetic benchmarks. The POCO X6 Pro 5G outperforms all of its rivals in the AnTuTu benchmark, achieving an impressive score of 1,315,523 points. This surpasses competitors like the Vivo V29 Pro, iQOO Neo 7 Pro, and OnePlus Nord 3. The score has even doubled compared to its predecessor, the POCO X5 Pro. In GeekBench, it records a solid score